

RGPV B.TECH. FIRST YEAR REVISION MODULE

English for Communication (BT-103) • Syllabus-Aligned PYQ Analysis & Prep Guide (2020–2025)

Exam Structure & Weightage Overview

Based on the multi-year longitudinal analysis of RGPV examination papers for BT-103 (Grading System & CBGS), the exam pattern remains strictly structured:

- **Format:** 8 comprehensive questions; candidates attempt **any 5 questions**.
- **Total Marks:** 70 Marks (14 marks per question, usually divided into 7 + 7 marks).
- **Question Allocation Trend:**
 - **Q.1 & Q.2:** Unit 1 (Applied Grammar) & Unit 2 (Vocabulary & Comprehension).
 - **Q.3 & Q.4:** Unit 3 (Communication Theory & Fundamentals).
 - **Q.5 & Q.6:** Unit 4 (Developing Writing Skills & Reports) & Unit 5 (Business Correspondence).
 - **Q.7 & Q.8:** Mixed Application Questions, Letters, Drafting, and Technical Short Notes.

UNIT	SYLLABUS DOMAIN	KEY FOCUS AREAS	APPROX. WEIGHTAGE
Unit 1	Identifying Common Errors in Writing	Voice Change, Direct/Indirect Speech, Subject-Verb Agreement, Articles, Prepositions	25% – 30% (20–28 Marks)
Unit 2	Vocabulary Building & Comprehension	Prefixes & Suffixes, Synonyms, Antonyms, Reading Comprehension	15% – 20% (14–21 Marks)
Unit 3	Communication	Communication Process, 7 Cs, Barriers, Verbal/Non-Verbal, Importance for Technical Students	20% – 25% (14–21 Marks)
Unit 4	Developing Writing Skills	Planning-Drafting-Editing, Précis Writing, Technical Definition/Description, Formal Reports	20% – 25% (14–21 Marks)
Unit 5	Business Correspondence	Business Letters, Job Applications & Resumes, Quotations, Complaints, Emails, Tenders	20% – 25% (14–21 Marks)

UNIT 1: IDENTIFYING COMMON ERRORS IN WRITING

A. Core Topic & Weightage Hierarchy

- **Active & Passive Voice & Direct/Indirect Speech:** Highest Priority. Featured in Q.1 across almost all examination papers.
- **Subject-Verb Agreement:** Highest Priority. Tested continuously via error correction or fill-in-the-blanks.
- **Articles, Prepositions & Sentence Structure:** High Priority. Standard 1-mark fill-in-the-blank items.

B. Categorized Question Bank

1. Most Important / Highly Repeated Questions

- **MOST IMPORTANT Subject-Verb Agreement:** Explain Subject-Verb Agreement with suitable examples.

Repeated PYQ Items:

- Mathematics (is/are) John's favorite subject.
- The committee (debates/debate) these questions carefully.
- Each of the employees ____ (is/are) contributing to the business.
- Either my shoes or your coat (is/are) always on the floor.
- Logistics ____ (is/are) not my area of expertise.

Repetition Count: 10 Times

- **MOST IMPORTANT Active and Passive Voice:** Differentiate between active and passive voice with illustrations / Change the voice as directed.

Repeated PYQ Items: Nishkarsh is playing football / They were doing good work / Sam has written a letter / The chef is preparing a delicious meal / The movie was directed by Christopher Nolan / Mr. Smith teaches me English / Let the door be shut / The work will be finished by me.

Repetition Count: 8 Times

- **MOST IMPORTANT Reported Speech (Direct & Indirect):** Explain reported speech with suitable examples / Convert into direct or indirect speech.

Repeated PYQ Items: He said, "His horse died in the night." / She said, "Oh no! I missed the train." / "Why haven't you phoned me?" he asked me / He said to me, "What are you doing?"

Repetition Count: 7 Times

2. Frequently Asked Questions

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED Articles & Prepositions:** Explain correct use of articles with suitable examples / Fill in correct articles (a, an, the) and prepositions (through, in, into, among, between).

Repetition Count: 6 Times

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED Sentence Structure & Editing:** Edit sentences for grammatical accuracy / Identify sentences as Declarative, Interrogative, Exclamatory, or Imperative.

Repetition Count: 4 Times

Unit 1 Key Rules & Formulas:

- **Subject-Verb Agreement:** Nouns joined by 'and' take plural verbs. Subjects preceded by *each, every, either...or, neither...nor* take singular verbs or agree with the nearest subject. Nouns like *Mathematics, Physics, News* take **SINGULAR** verbs.
- **Voice Change Formula:** Active: [Subject + Verb + Object] → Passive: [Object + Auxiliary Verb + Past Participle (V3) +

by + Subject].

- **Reported Speech:** Present tenses change to corresponding Past tenses. Universal truths remain unchanged. Interrogative sentences convert to assertive statements.

C. Most Expected Questions for Upcoming Exams

1. Explain **Subject-Verb Agreement** with 5 illustrative sentence examples.
2. Convert the following into **Indirect Speech**:
 - (a) The teacher said, "The earth revolves around the sun."
 - (b) She asked me, "Why are you submitting the project late?"
3. Convert the following sentences from **Active to Passive Voice**:
 - (a) The engineering team developed new software.
 - (b) Who solved this complex numerical?

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY BUILDING AND COMPREHENSION

A. Core Topic & Weightage Hierarchy

- **Prefixes & Suffixes:** Highest Priority. Standard 7-mark question in Q.2 across recent papers.
- **Synonyms & Antonyms:** Highest Priority. Frequently asked as full 7-mark questions or vocabulary lists.
- **Reading Comprehension:** High Priority. Includes passage reading, answering questions, or explaining comprehension improvement techniques.

B. Categorized Question Bank

1. Most Important / Highly Repeated Questions

- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Prefixes and Suffixes:** Explain prefixes and suffixes used in English vocabulary with five examples for each / Add appropriate prefix or suffix to words in parenthesis.
Repeated Root Words: behave → misbehave; companion → companionship; bore → boredom; child → childish; happy → unhappy; employ → unemployment.
Repetition Count: 5 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Synonyms and Antonyms:** Write short notes on synonyms and antonyms with five examples for each / Write antonyms and synonyms for given words.
Repeated Words for Antonyms: Knowledge (Ignorance), Better (Worse), Regular (Irregular), Mortal (Immortal), Include (Exclude), Enormous (Tiny), Exodus (Influx), Occupied (Vacant), Before (After), Poor (Rich), Tight (Loose), Tidy (Untidy).
Repetition Count: 7 Times

2. Frequently Asked Questions

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Reading Comprehension:** What is reading comprehension? Explain methods and techniques to improve reading comprehension skills.
Repetition Count: 4 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Unseen Passages:** Answer questions based on passage reading (e.g., Passage on *Robert Bruce and the Spider* or *Punctuality*).

Unit 2 Key Vocabulary & Mechanics Summary:

- **Prefix:** A word element added to the **beginning** of a root word (un-happy, mis-behave, re-write).
- **Suffix:** A word element added to the **end** of a root word (child-ish, employ-ment, grace-ful).
- **Reading Comprehension Techniques:** Skimming (getting main idea), Scanning (locating specific facts), and Critical Reading.

C. Most Expected Questions for Upcoming Exams

1. Explain how **Prefixes and Suffixes** help in vocabulary building. Give 5 examples for each.
2. Write the **Antonyms** of the following words: *Knowledge, Mortal, Enormous, Occupied, Feasibility, Before, Tidy*.
3. What is **Reading Comprehension**? Discuss 4 techniques to improve reading speed and understanding for engineering students.

UNIT 3: COMMUNICATION

A. Core Topic & Weightage Hierarchy

- **Process of Communication:** Absolute High Priority. Mandatory 7-mark question in almost every session.
- **Barriers to Communication:** Absolute High Priority. Repeated continuously with methods to overcome barriers.
- **Non-Verbal Communication:** High Priority. Tested in 6 out of 10 papers.
- **7 Cs of Communication & Importance for Technical Students:** High Priority.

B. Categorized Question Bank

1. Most Important / Highly Repeated Questions

- **MOST IMPORTANT** Define communication. Describe the **Process / Cycle of Communication** with a neat diagram.
Repetition Count: 7 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** Discuss **Barriers to Communication** and explain the methods/strategies to overcome them.
Repetition Count: 6 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** Explain **Non-verbal Communication** with examples. Discuss the importance of body language, kinesics, and gestures in communication.
Repetition Count: 6 Times

2. Frequently Asked Questions

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** Explain the **7 Cs of Effective Communication** with examples.
Repetition Count: 3 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** Discuss the **Importance of Communication for Technical/Engineering Students**. List five reasons why communication skills are essential for career growth.
Repetition Count: 4 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** Differentiate between **Oral and Written Communication** (benefits & drawbacks) and **One-way vs. Two-way Communication**.
Repetition Count: 5 Times

Unit 3 Communication Blueprint:

- **Communication Cycle:** Sender → Encoding → Message → Channel/Medium → Receiver → Decoding → Feedback.
- **The 7 Cs Checklist:** Clarity, Conciseness, Concreteness, Correctness, Coherent, Completeness, Courtesy.
- **Barriers Classification:** Physical/Environmental, Psychological/Emotional, Semantic/Linguistic, Socio-Cultural, Organizational.
- **Non-Verbal Categories:** Kinesics (Body Language), Proxemics (Space), Paralanguage (Tone & Pitch), Chronemics (Time).

C. Most Expected Questions for Upcoming Exams

1. Define Communication. Draw and explain the complete **Communication Process** including Sender, Encoder, Channel, Receiver, Decoder, and Feedback.
2. What are the major **Barriers to Communication** in an engineering workplace? How can an engineer overcome them?

3. Explain the **7 Cs of Communication** and their significance in professional interactions.

UNIT 4: DEVELOPING WRITING SKILLS

A. Core Topic & Weightage Hierarchy

- **Précis Writing / Writing Precisely:** Highest Priority. Appears as a full question or short note in 8 out of 10 papers.
- **Structure of Formal Reports & Report Types:** Highest Priority. Tested in every single paper.
- **Planning, Drafting, and Editing:** High Priority.
- **Technical Definition & Technical Description:** High Priority.

B. Categorized Question Bank

1. Most Important / Highly Repeated Questions

- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Précis Writing:** What is précis writing? Differentiate between precise writing and précis. Explain the steps and rules for writing a good précis.
Repetition Count: 8 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Structure of Formal Report:** What is report writing? Explain the essential structural elements of a formal technical report (Title Page, Abstract, Table of Contents, Introduction, Body, Conclusion, Recommendations, References).
Repetition Count: 8 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Technical Definition & Description:** What is technical definition and technical description? Write the technical description of a common object (e.g., Electric Fan).
Repetition Count: 6 Times

2. Frequently Asked Questions

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Planning, Drafting, and Editing:** Explain the steps involved in planning, drafting, and editing in technical writing.
Repetition Count: 5 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Specialized Reports:** Differentiate between a **Laboratory Report**, **Progress Report**, and **Trouble Report**.
Repetition Count: 6 Times

Unit 4 Rules & Structural Layouts:

- **Précis Rules:** Length must be approx. **1/3rd** of original word count. Always write in indirect speech, 3rd person, and past tense. Provide a clear, bold Title.
- **Technical Definition Formula:** Term = Class + Differentiating Characteristics.
- **Formal Report Structure:** Cover Page → Title Page → Executive Summary → Table of Contents → Introduction → Body Paragraphs → Conclusions → Recommendations → Appendices.

C. Most Expected Questions for Upcoming Exams

1. Explain the complete structural elements of a **Formal Technical Report**.
2. Enumerate the rules and guidelines for summarizing a passage effectively via **Précis Writing**.

3. Differentiate between:

- (a) Laboratory Report and Progress Report
- (b) Technical Definition and Technical Description

UNIT 5: BUSINESS CORRESPONDENCE

A. Core Topic & Weightage Hierarchy

- **Resume & Cover Letter / Job Application:** Highest Priority. Full 7 or 14-mark question in 9 out of 10 papers.
- **Business Letters (Importance, Parts & Layout):** Highest Priority.
- **Letters of Complaint & Enquiry:** High Priority.
- **Tenders & Quotations:** High Priority.
- **E-mail Writing & Etiquette:** High Priority.

B. Categorized Question Bank

1. Most Important / Highly Repeated Questions

- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Resume Writing:**
(a) Write the contents and guidelines for writing a good **Resume**.
(b) Differentiate between a **Resume** and a **Curriculum Vitae (CV)**.
(c) Draft your Resume along with a Covering Letter for the post of Software Engineer or Management Trainee.
Repetition Count: 9 Times
- **MOST IMPORTANT** **Business Letters:** Explain the importance, essential qualities, parts, and standard block layout of **Business Letters**.
Repetition Count: 6 Times

2. Frequently Asked Questions

- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Letter of Complaint & Enquiry:** What is a letter of complaint? Draft a complaint letter regarding poor service or defective goods. Draft an enquiry letter regarding course details/fees.
Repetition Count: 4 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **Tenders & Quotations:** What is a tender notice? Differentiate between Open Tender and Limited Tender. Differentiate between Calling/Sending Quotation and Tender.
Repetition Count: 5 Times
- **FREQUENTLY ASKED** **E-mail Writing:** What are the basics and etiquette of email writing? What do **CC** and **BCC** mean? Draft an email requesting leave or discussing schedules.
Repetition Count: 5 Times

Unit 5 Standard Resume & Correspondence Layout:

1. **Resume Elements:** Header → Career Objective → Education (Reverse Chronological) → Technical Skills → Projects & Internships → Soft Skills → Personal Details.
2. **Cover Letter Format:** Sender's Address → Date → Receiver's Designation/Address → Subject Line → Salutation → Body (3 Paragraphs) → Sign-off ('Yours sincerely').
3. **Email CC vs. BCC:** CC (Carbon Copy) reveals recipient list to all; BCC (Blind Carbon Copy) hides recipient email addresses for privacy.

C. Most Expected Questions for Upcoming Exams

1. Draft a professional **Resume** along with a formal **Cover Letter** applying for the post of Assistant Software Engineer.

2. Explain the structural parts and block layout of a **Business Letter**.
3. Differentiate between:
 - (a) **CC and BCC** in emails
 - (b) **Quotation and Tender Notice**

LAST-MINUTE MASTER REVISION BLUEPRINT

High-Frequency Exam Deliverables Checklist

SYLLABUS TOPIC	EXPECTED OUTPUT IN ANSWER SHEET	PRIORITY / PROBABILITY
Grammar Correction	Sentence conversion for Voice, Reported Speech, and Subject-Verb Agreement.	100% (Q.1 & Q.2)
Communication Cycle	7-stage flowchart diagram (Sender → Encoder → Channel → Receiver → Decoder → Feedback).	100% (Q.3)
Barriers & Solutions	Classification table (Physical, Psychological, Semantic) + 5 remedies.	95%
Précis Writing	Summarizing passage to 1/3rd length + providing a bold Title.	90%
Resume & Application	Full 1-page structured Resume + Cover Letter in standard block layout.	95%
Formal Report Structure	Listing & explaining sections from Title Page to Appendices.	90%
Specialized Reports	Comparison table of Lab Report, Progress Report, and Trouble Report.	85%